



Locomotive in ruins

At the Richmond and Petersburg Railroad depot a wrecked engine is surveyed. Damage both by the Confederates in retreat and the advancing Union army added to the heavy postwar cost borne by the South.

The effects in the North

While Union forces suffered up to a third more casualties than the Confederates, the war had a less damaging effect on the North. Only half of the military-aged men had enlisted in the army or navy, one-quarter of them immigrants. In contrast to the Confederates, a lower proportion died in actual service—roughly one-sixth. The North had far greater financial, agricultural, and industrial resources. A better managed economy, including increased taxes, national currency, and successful bonds drives, contained wartime inflation to 80 percent. Suffering was largely offset by high employment and a rise in wages. Food production rose to meet military demand and voluntary efforts by civilians supplemented war needs for rations, clothing, and medical supplies. The remaining war debts were a fraction of those incurred by the Confederacy and no large impediment to the postwar economy. The war slowed immigration